CANTON DEV FUND STRATEGY

DPM Debug: Grant Proposal Strategy

Analysis of approved Canton Dev Fund proposals and a strategy for Lazer's first grant submission, a visual debugging plugin for Daml.

Lazer Technologies · Internal Strategy Deck · April 2026

CONTENTS

What's In This Deck

01	Approved Proposals Overview	What got funded and for how much
02	Patterns and Insights	What gets approved and why
03	Our Opportunity	Why a debugger, why now
04	Budget and Milestones	667,000 CC over 10 weeks
05	Differentiation and Next Steps	How we stand out and what to do next

PART 1: APPROVED PROPOSALS

What the Foundation Has Funded

Eight approved PRs from the Canton Dev Fund, analyzed at $0.15 per CC.

PR	PROPOSAL	PROPOSER	CC AMOUNT	USD VALUE	TIMELINE
#159	**CCTools Community Toolkit**	0xScoutr	500,000	**$75,000**	5 months
#130	**Daml Package Analyzer**	Certora	2,010,000	**$301,500**	5 months
#53	**ISS-Based BFT Ordering**	Digital Asset	Undisclosed	**Est. $500K+**	8 months
#49	**Daml OS Maintenance**	Digital Asset	1,000,000/mo	**$150,000/mo**	Recurring
#48	**Canton OS Maintenance**	Digital Asset	2,000,000/mo	**$300,000/mo**	Recurring
#47	**Splice OS Maintenance**	Digital Asset	1,000,000/mo	**$150,000/mo**	Recurring
#32	**Daml3 Training Program**	Obsidian Systems	5,290,000	**$740,600**	34 weeks
#24	**Multi-VM Canton (EVM)**	Zenith	2,000,000/mo	**$300,000/mo**	12 months

How They Structured Milestones

CCTools (#159)

3 milestones, front-loaded: 200K CC (40%) in M1 for core learn-to-earn platform. 175K for infra and DeFi dashboard. 125K for API and mobile PWA.

Certora (#130)

4 milestones, back-loaded: 335K CC each for M1 and M2 (build + initial adoption). 670K each for M3 and M4 (tied to 5+ production deployments each).

Obsidian (#32)

4 milestones over 34 weeks. 5,290,000 CC total (revised down 20% from original $927K ask). Modules, certification exams, and 12 coding videos.

DA Maintenance

PRs #47, #48, #49: rolling monthly milestones. 1M to 2M CC/mo for ongoing repo maintenance. Acceptance: response times, release cadence, PR reviews.

What Gets Approved and Why

STRUCTURE
3 to 5 Milestones

Fixed-scope projects use 3 to 5 milestones with explicit, testable acceptance criteria. Not vague deliverables, but conditions like "5 production deployments" or "API accessible with validator tier active."

FRAMING
Public Good Infra

Every approved proposal is framed as public-good infrastructure or core protocol work. Dapps and use-case demos are borderline. Open-source licensing (MIT or Apache 2.0) is table stakes.

CHAMPIONS
Named Sponsor

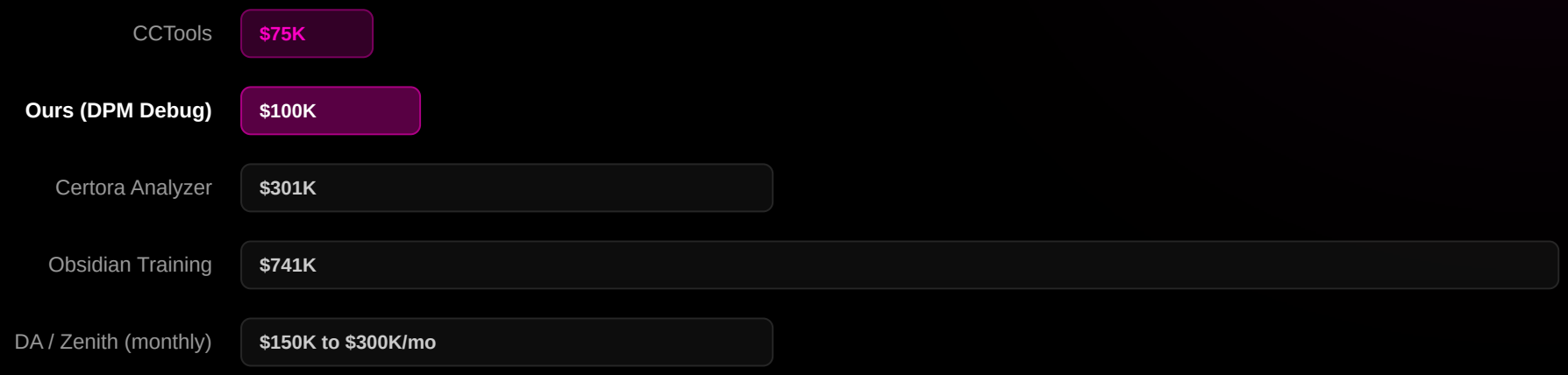
Every proposal has a champion from the Foundation or committee. Jatin Pandya offered to champion ours and review drafts before submission.

CREDIBILITY
Prove It First

CCTools had 20K users before applying. Obsidian voluntarily cut scope by 20%. The strongest proposals show cost discipline and traction, not just ambition.

Grant Budget Landscape

Where our $100K ask sits relative to approved proposals.



- **$100K is modest and credible** for a first proposal. Above the floor, well below specialized tooling asks. Opens the door for follow-up grants.

PART 3: OUR OPPORTUNITY

Why a Debugger, Why Now

> *"A really, really good debugging experience is what lacks on top of Canton. If you ask me personally what I would love to see in the ecosystem, I would say a really good debugging experience."*
>
> **Jatin Pandya, Canton Foundation**
> Call with Lazer, April 14, 2026

- **Foundation DX survey** flagged "visual debugging" and "transaction visibility" as top missing tools
- **Jatin offered to champion** our proposal and review drafts before submission

NO OVERLAP WITH EXISTING PROPOSALS

Certora = Compile-Time Static Analysis
Security auditing of .dar files. Finds potential issues before deployment.

Ours = Runtime Dev Debugging
Visual transaction trees, structured test output, debug logs. Helps developers during active development.

DA Maintenance = Keeps DPM Working
We extend DPM with a plugin. Adds capability, doesn't duplicate effort.

Obsidian = Training Content
Educational modules. Our tooling makes learning-by-doing faster.

PART 4: BUDGET AND MILESTONES

Proposed Grant Structure

$10,000 per week at $250/hr, 10 weeks, 3 milestones.

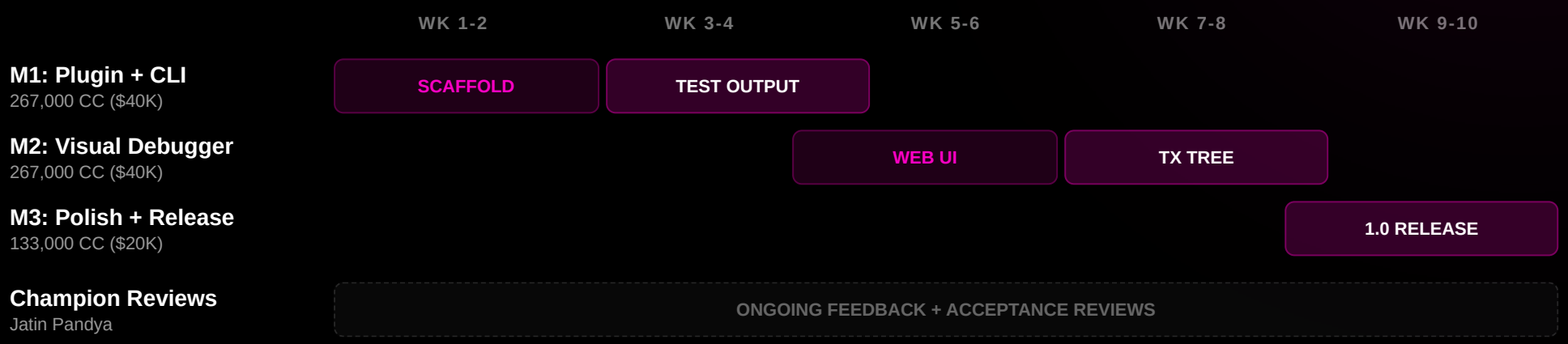
DURATION
10 weeks

GRANT ASK
667,000 CC (~$100K)

PAYOUT
Milestone-based in CC

MILESTONE	FOCUS	DURATION	CC	USD
M1	DPM plugin scaffold, structured CLI test output, assertion diffs, source linking	4 weeks	267,000	$40,000
M2	Visual transaction tree (web UI), debug/trace log panel, filter and search	4 weeks	267,000	$40,000
M3	Snapshot/replay, end-to-end docs, walkthrough video, 1.0 release	2 weeks	133,000	$20,000
Total		**10 weeks**	667,000	$100,000

10-Week Delivery Timeline



DELIVERABLES

- DPM Plugin
- CLI Debugger
- Web UI
- Snapshot/Replay
- Docs + Video
- MIT License

PART 5: DIFFERENTIATION

Why This Wins

Builds on DPM

Jatin specifically recommended this architecture. Extends the tool the Foundation already funds (PR #49) rather than duplicating infrastructure.

#1 Cited Gap

The Foundation's own DX survey and Jatin's direct feedback both identify visual debugging as the single biggest missing piece in the Daml developer experience.

Complementary

Runtime debugging (ours) complements Certora's compile-time static analysis. Different layer, different users, zero overlap.

Credible First Ask

$100K ($10K/week) covers our full $250/hr rate and positions Lazer for larger follow-up proposals after we deliver.

Beyond the Grant Money

COMPETENCY **Learn Daml**	Solves our chicken-and-egg problem. We can't win Canton client work without Daml experience, and we can't get Daml experience without building something. This is the something.
REPUTATION **Dev Tooling Cred**	Contributing core dev tooling puts us on the map as serious builders, not just another studio. The Foundation's Dev Shop program rewards this with referrals.
PIPELINE **Preferred Referrals**	Jatin is building a program to match studios with companies that want to build on Canton. Proving competency via this grant is the fastest path to being a preferred referral.
ECONOMICS **Liquid CC Payouts**	No lockup. Jatin confirmed CC can be converted to USDC immediately. At $0.15/CC, $100K (667,000 CC) covers our full $250/hr rate at $10K per week.

NEXT STEPS

Ready to submit.

01 Jesse and Garrett greenlight the proposal direction

02 Sayeed shares draft with Jatin on Telegram for feedback

03 Incorporate Jatin's feedback and finalize proposal

04 Submit PR to canton-foundation/canton-dev-fund

05 Jatin champions the PR through committee review

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